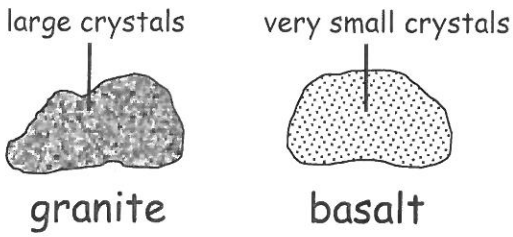
W.S.50. **Types of rock.** Name .....

Rocks can be divided into three main types depending on how they were formed. Read the information below about the three types of rock.

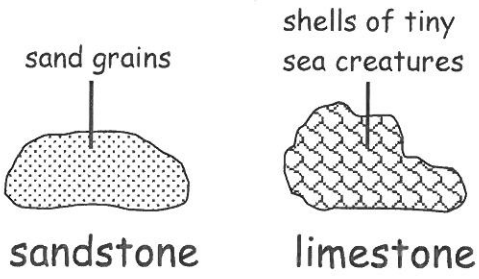
Igneous rocks.

These are formed when molten magma cools down and becomes solid. They are made of tiny crystals. If the magma cools quickly on the surface of the Earth then the crystals are small. If the magma cools slowly, deeper in the Earth's crust, then the crystals are larger. Igneous rocks are very hard.



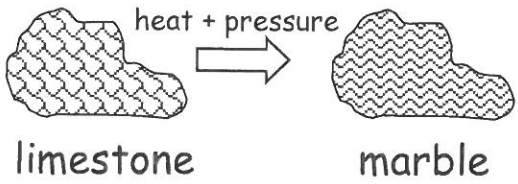
Sedimentary rocks.

These are made from layers of SEDIMENT (small particles) on the bottom of rivers or seas. The sediments are compressed as more layers build up on top of them. The particles then become cemented together to form solid rocks. The layers of rock are called STRATA. Sedimentary rocks have a grainy structure and they easily crumble.



Metamorphic (changed) rocks.

These are formed from igneous or sedimentary rocks which are changed by heat or pressure deep underground. They are usually harder than the rocks that formed them.



Exercise - Complete the sentences below.

1) Igneous rocks form when M _ _ _ _ cools down.

2) Granite contains L _ _ _ _ crystals because the magma cooled slowly.

3) Sedimentary rocks are made from particles called S _ _ _ _ _ _ _ _

4) Layers of rock are called S _ _ _ _ _

5) Sedimentary rocks easily C _ _ _ _ _ _

6) Metamorphic rocks have been changed by H _ _ _ or pressure.

7) Heat and pressure changes limestone into M _ _ _ _ _

KS3 Science Revision Worksheets Special Edition © P. Hill, Beaver Educational Resources 2000. Registered to Fitzalan High School. CF11 8XB.